

DANSA Lab – Weekly Progress Report

Prepared by: Ahmed Azmaine Alvee

Date: October 24, 2025

Affiliation: Undergraduate Research Assistant, DANSA Lab

Program: PURE Summer Research Program

Link: <https://ucalgary.ca/experiential-learning/undergraduate-research/pure>

2. Website Development Progress



- **Sections Completed:**
 - **Home Page:** Developed and designed to serve as the primary landing page. It includes lab introduction, mission statement, and a visual hero section for improved engagement.
 - **Team Section:** Showcases all current DANSA Lab members, including researchers, faculty, and collaborators, with uniform profile cards and professional layout.

- **Technical Details:**
 - The website structure is fully coded in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
 - CSS styles are modularized in `site.css` for maintainability.
 - Images and layout are optimized for accessibility and responsive display.
 - **Design Improvements Made:**
 - Enhanced transparency of the background for better visual balance.
 - Enlarged team member photos for better visibility and aesthetic uniformity.
 - Refined typography and spacing for a cleaner user interface.
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3. PURE Program Enrollment

- Successfully **enrolled in the PURE (Program for Undergraduate Research Experience)** at the University of Calgary.
 - The selected **research topic focuses on health-related computational approaches**, which aligns with DANSA Lab's interdisciplinary work in data analytics and system design.
 - The PURE program link and application reference:
<https://ucalgary.ca/experiential-learning/undergraduate-research/pure>
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4. Upcoming Goals

- **Next Week's Objectives:**
 - Add a **Publications Page** to the website.
 - Begin drafting the **research summary** for PURE documentation (Health-focused project scope).
 - Integrate a consistent color palette across all pages for brand identity.
 - Prepare an **interactive "Contact" section** with social and academic profile links.
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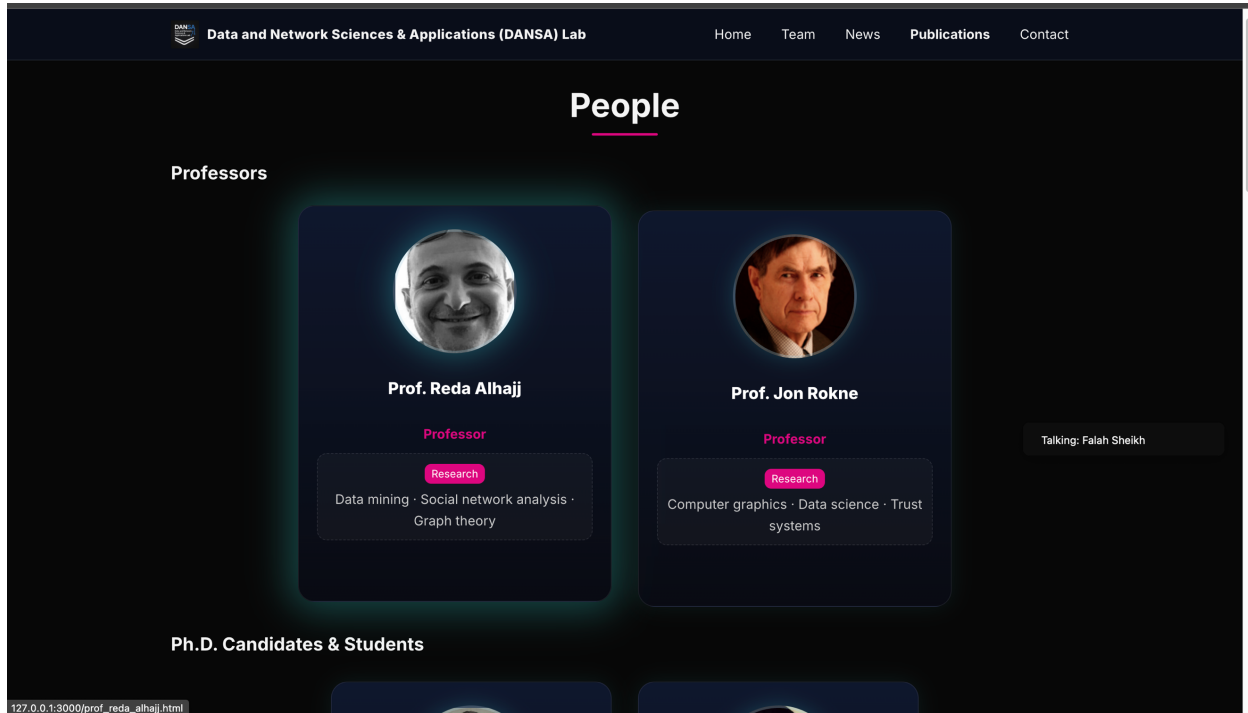
5. Reflections

Developing the DANSA Lab website has strengthened understanding of user-centric design and academic web presentation. The PURE program enrollment marks a significant milestone toward contributing to the university's ongoing health research efforts.

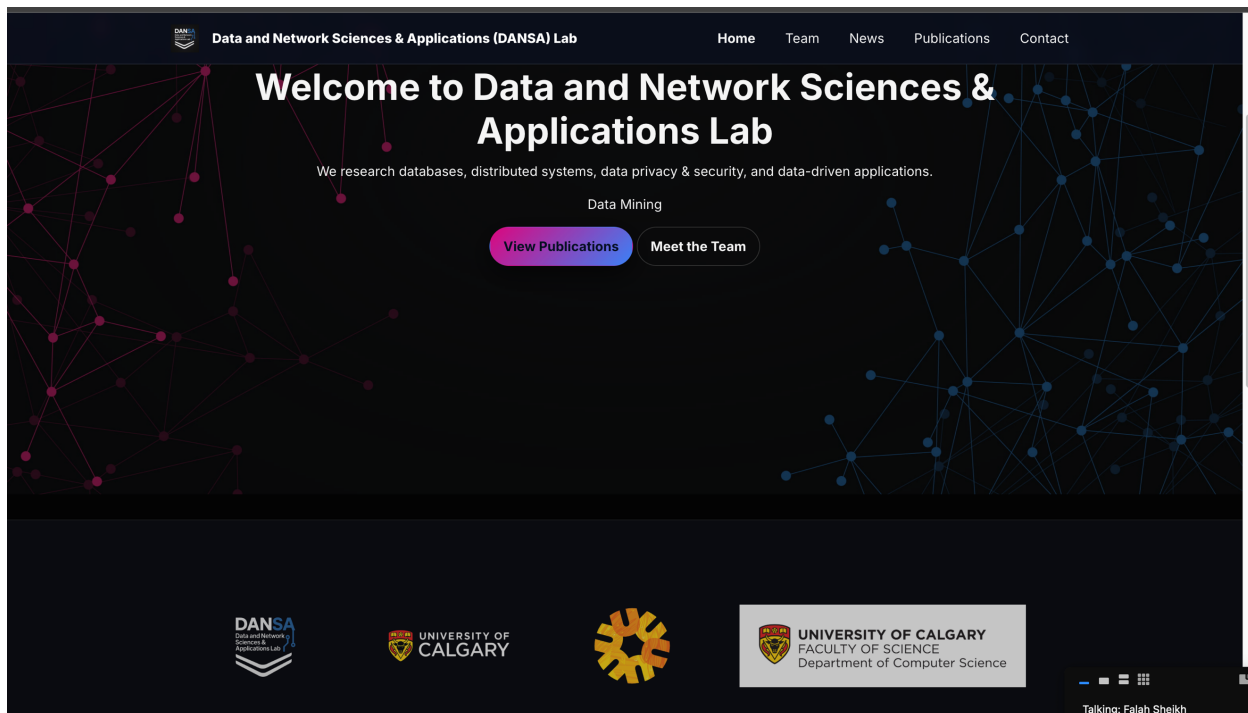
6. Attachments

- Screenshots of the current **Home** and **Team** sections.
- Link to the PURE program page for reference.

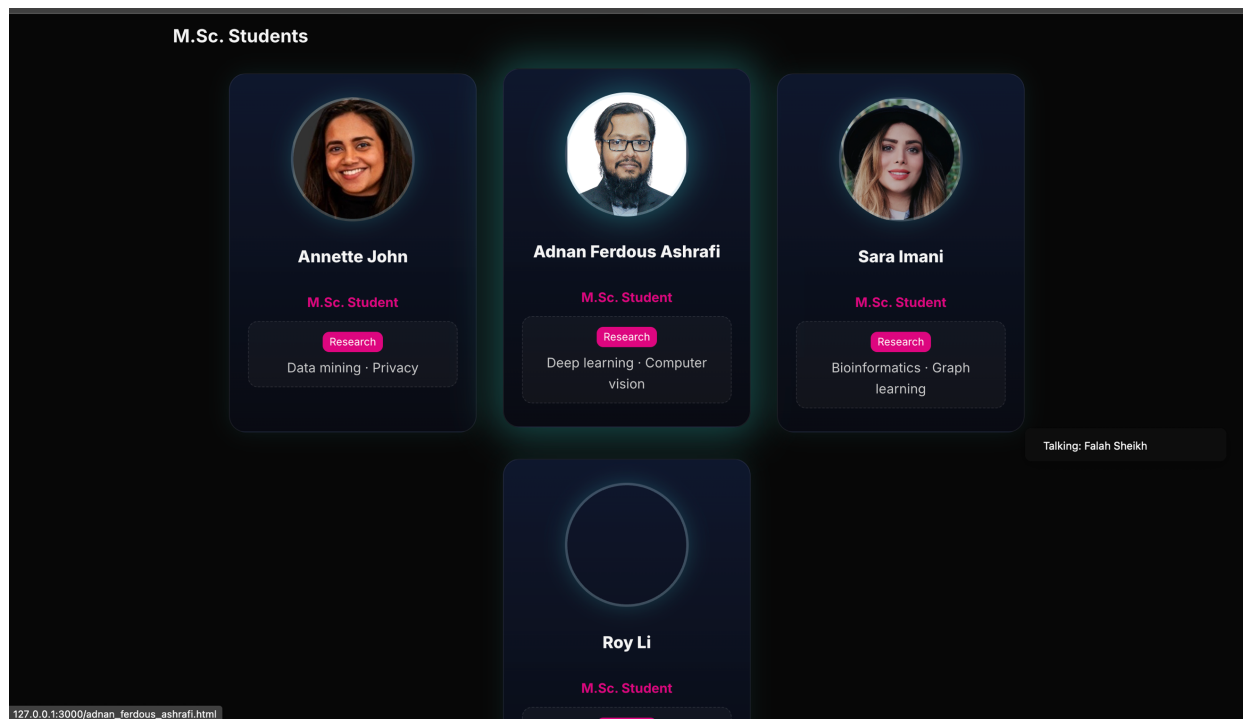
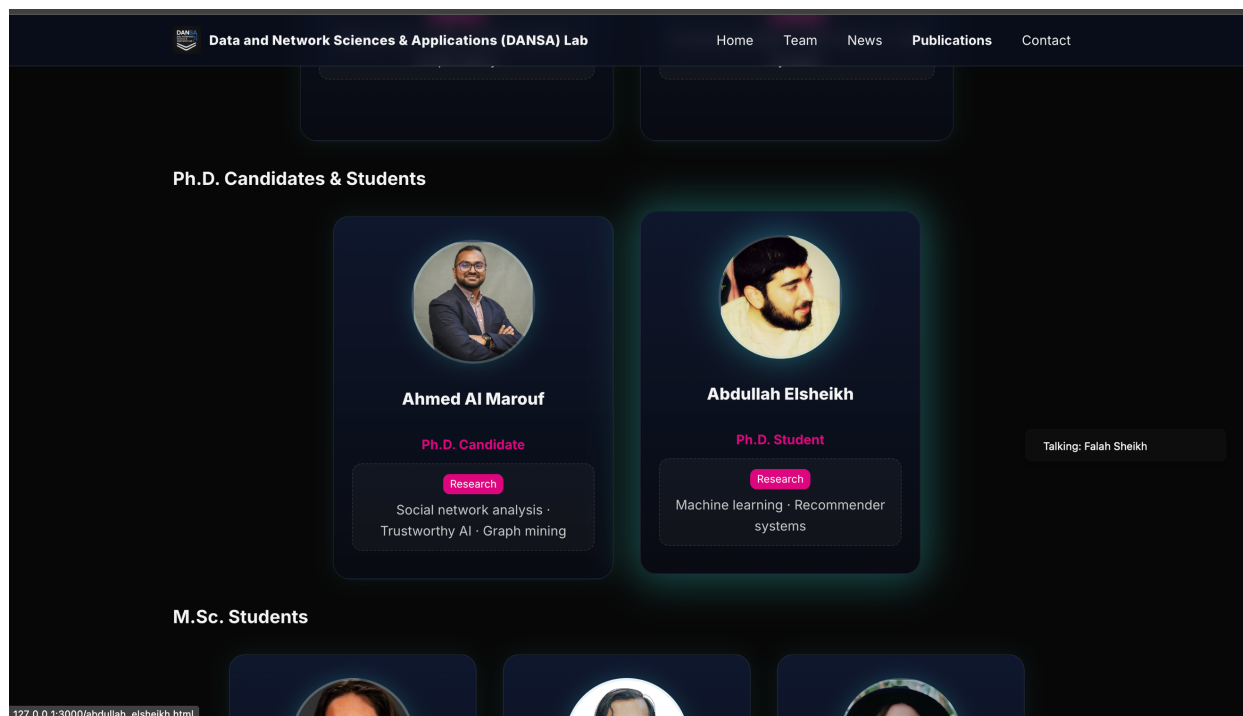
- Professors:



Home:



Team:



Publications:

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Publications

Prof. Reda Alhajj and Prof. Jon G. Rokne

Investigating The Roles of microRNAs / lncRNAs in Characterizing Breast Cancer Subtypes and Prognosis. — Tansel Özyer, Reyhan Zeynep Pek, Muhammed Talha Zavalisiz, Melis Serdar, Sleiman Alhajj, Lama Alhajj, Jon G. Rokne, Reda Alhajj, Kashfia Sailunaz (2023) · [Link](#)

A survey on brain tumor image analysis. — Kashfia Sailunaz, Sleiman Alhajj, Tansel Özyer, Jon G. Rokne, Reda Alhajj (2024) · [Link](#)

A survey of artificial intelligence/machine learning-based trends for prostate cancer analysis. — Kashfia Sailunaz, Deniz Bestepe, Lama Alhajj, Tansel Özyer, Jon G. Rokne, Reda Alhajj (2024) · [Link](#)

A comparative study of different pre-trained deep learning models and custom CNN for pancreatic tumor detection. — Muhammed Talha Zavalisiz, Sleiman Alhajj, Kashfia Sailunaz, Tansel Özyer, Reda Alhajj (2023) · [Link](#)

KoExPubMed: A Tool for Effective and Customized Knowledge Extraction from PubMed. — Tansel Özyer, Reda Alhajj, Jon G. Rokne, Kashfia Sailunaz, Gabriela Jurca, Deniz Bestepe, Lama Alhajj, Busra Kartay (2023) · [Link](#)

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2025-09-01 Paper accepted at XYZ 2025 — knowledge graphs.

2025-08-15 New Ph.D. student joined the lab.

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Biography:



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Prof. Jon George Rokne

Professor • DANSA Lab

Affiliation: Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

Research: Computer Graphics, Geographic Information Systems, Data Science

Google Scholar: [Scholar Profile](#)

ORCID: [0000-0002-3439-2917](#)

LinkedIn: [jon-rokne](#)

Jon Rokne is a Professor in the Department of Computer Science at the University of Calgary where he chaired the department from 1989 to 1996. He obtained an M. Sc. from the University of Alberta and a Ph. D. from the University of Calgary, both in applied mathematics with a numerical analysis emphasis. His main applied mathematics interests have been interval analysis and global optimization where he has co-authored three books. In computer science the focus has been computer graphics and physically and biologically based computer simulations with publications on the visual simulation of leaves, auroras, sky, Chinese calligraphy, seismic visualization, ball lightning, social networks and data science. He has published one jointly authored computer science book entitled "Light Interaction with Plants". He has also published papers in the areas of computational geometry, and computer-aided design. He has been actively involved in IEEE including chairing the IEEE-PSPB 2011-2012. He has been a co-organizer of ASONAM. He is a co-editor of the Encyclopedia of Social Networks and Mining, the publicity chair for ASONAM. His extracurricular activities have included skiing, hiking and mountaineering. He is married and his wife teaches in the Faculty of Education of the University of Calgary. He has two sons.

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Prof. Reda Alhajj

Professor, DANSA Lab

Affiliation: Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

Research: Databases, Data Mining, Social Network Analysis

DBLP: [DBLP Profile](#)

Reda Alhajj (Senior Member, IEEE) is a tenured professor in the Department of Computer Science at the University of Calgary, Alberta, Canada. He is also affiliated with Medipol University, Istanbul, Turkey, and University of Southern Denmark, Odense, Denmark. He published over 500 papers in refereed international journals, conferences, and edited books. He served on the program committee of several international conferences. He is founding editor in chief of the Springer premier journal "Social Networks Analysis and Mining", founding editor-in-chief of Springer Series "Lecture Notes on Social Networks", founding editor-in-chief of Springer journal "Network Modeling Analysis in Health Informatics and Bioinformatics", founding co-editor-in-chief of Springer "Encyclopedia on Social Networks Analysis and Mining" (ranked top 3rd in most downloaded sources in computer science in 2018), founding steering chair of the flagship conference "IEEE/ACM International Conference on Advances in Social Network Analysis and Mining", and three accompanying symposiums FAB (for big data analysis), FOSINT-SI (for homeland security and intelligence services) and HI-BI-BI (for health informatics and bioinformatics). He is member of the editorial board of the Journal of Information Assurance and Security, Journal of Data Mining and Bioinformatics, Journal of Data Mining, Modeling and Management; he has been guest editor of a number of special issues and edited a number of conference proceedings. Dr. Alhajj's primary work and research interests focus on various aspects of data science and big data with emphasis on areas like: (1) scalable techniques and structures for data management and mining, (2) social network analysis with applications in computational biology and bioinformatics, homeland security, disaster management, etc., (3) sequence analysis with emphasis on domains like financial, weather, traffic, energy, etc., (4) XML, schema integration and re-engineering. He currently leads a large research group of PhD and MSc candidates. He received best graduate supervision award and community service award at the University of Calgary. He recently mentored a number of successful teams, including SANO who ranked first in the Microsoft Imagine Cup Competition in Canada and received KFC Innovation Award in the World Finals held in Russia, TRAK who ranked in the top 15 teams in the open data analysis competition in Canada, Go2There who ranked first in the Imagine Camp competition organized by Microsoft Canada, Funiverse who ranked first in Microsoft Imagine Cup Competition in Canada.

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News

2025-09-01 Paper accepted at XYZ 2025 — knowledge graphs.

2025-08-15 New Ph.D. student joined the lab.